

What's New

5 August 2026

- Addition of a NEW onshore BMSB treatment option Ethyl Formate.
- Removal of the Rolled Goods Policy
- Removal of the Safeguarding Scheme

Seasonal measures for Brown marmorated stink bug (BMSB)

BMSB seasonal measures will apply to targeted goods manufactured in or shipped from target risk countries, that have been shipped between 1 September and 30 April (inclusive), and to vessels that berth, load, or tranship from target risk countries within the same period.

Note: The shipped on board date, as indicated on the Ocean Bill of Lading, is the date used to determine when goods have been shipped. “Gate in” dates and times will not be accepted to determine when goods are shipped.

We review the measures throughout the season and may make necessary adjustments based on detections of BMSB and changes in the risk pathways.

- If your goods are classed as [target high risk](#), they will require mandatory treatment.
- If your goods are classed as [target risk](#), they will be subject to random inspection.
- If your goods are not found in either category, they are not subject to BMSB measures, however, will be subject to the measures if packed with target high risk or risk goods.

Goods shipped in iso-tanks and as bulk-in-holds of cargo vessels are not subject to the measures.

Note: Where full kegs (beer, kombucha, etc) are imported into Australia and are required to be declared as a separate commodity by Australian Border Force (ABF), the department will accept a manufacturer’s declaration confirming the kegs are being imported full and will release from BMSB seasonal measures without further intervention. These kegs can also be referred to as reusable/returnable steel totes and/or casks.

Treatment of target high risk goods

- Target high risk goods treated in target risk countries must be treated by a treatment provider listed as ‘approved’ on the [List of treatment providers](#).
- Treatment certificates from target risk countries will not be accepted from unregistered treatment providers or treatment providers listed as ‘suspended’, ‘withdrawn’ or ‘under review’ on the [List of Treatment Providers](#).
 - Containerised goods will be directed for onshore treatment.
 - Break bulk will be directed for export.

Note: Treatment providers that wish to become registered to conduct BMSB treatments can do so under [AusTreat](#).

Break bulk goods

- Break bulk includes those goods shipped on flat racks and in open top containers.
- All target high risk goods shipped as break bulk must be treated offshore prior to arrival into Australia.
- Untreated break bulk will be denied discharge or directed for export.
- Onshore treatment is not permitted.
- Shipper Owned Containers (SOCs) and FCL containers that have been modified, such as those used to house in-built power generators, filtration plants, portable accommodation etc. are no longer sealed six hard sided containers and are considered break bulk cargo.
- Automated Entry Processing for Commodity (AEP COMM) arrangements for BMSB is permitted for break bulk goods. See relevant BICON commodities for assessment and outcomes.

Note: If you are importing target high risk goods as break bulk (including flat rack and open top containers) and it has not been treated offshore prior to arrival, you must answer 'YES' to community protection question 642 (BIOSECURITY: ARE THE GOODS ARRIVING IN AN OPEN TOP/FLAT RACK CONTAINER OR AS BREAK BULK, AND DO NOT MEET OFFSHORE BMSB TREATMENT REQUIREMENTS?). This includes Automated Entry Processing for Commodity (AEP COMM) lodgements.

Containerised goods (FCL, FCX)

- Containerised cargo arriving in sealed six hard sided containers with target high risk goods can be treated offshore, or onshore at the container level.
- Refrigerated containers (operating and non-operating) and hard top sealed containers (ISO22U6/ISO22UP, ISO42U6/ISO42UP and ISO45U6/ISO45UP) are deemed to be the same as six hard sided sealed containers.
- Onshore treatment of goods is to occur at the container level. Deconsolidation or removal of goods from the container will not be permitted prior to treatment.
- Containers should be packed in a manner that will enable effective onshore treatment at the container level to avoid possible export of the container.
- AEP COMM arrangements for BMSB is permitted for containerised goods shipped as FCL (Full Container Load) and FCX (Full Container Consolidated). See relevant BICON commodities for assessment and outcomes.
- A sealing declaration can be utilised for FCL / FCX containers in the following circumstances:
 - Goods were containerised and sealed prior to 1 September, but shipped on board after this date; or
 - The bill of lading does not state the shipped-on board date; or
 - Target high risk goods were manufactured, packed and sealed in a container in a non-target risk country but have been shipped from a target risk country; or

- Goods were sealed inside the container within 120 hours of treatment occurring offshore (for treatments conducted prior to 1 December).

Note: Sealing declarations must be completed and signed by either the exporter, freight forwarder, or shipping company at the port of origin.

Note: Container tracking information is not an acceptable form of evidence to verify when goods were loaded on board the vessel or when goods were sealed in a container.

Containerised goods shipped as Less than Container Load (LCL) consignments and Freight of all Kinds (FAK) containers

LCL and FAK containers with target high risk goods will be managed at the container level for BMSB risk prior to deconsolidation. Once BMSB risk has been managed, the consignments within these containers will be processed at the Full Import Declaration (FID) level for all other biosecurity intervention (if applicable).

See the [Management of LCL/FAK containers](#) web page for more details.

Airfreight

Random inspections will apply to target high risk goods shipped as airfreight from United States of America and China between 1 September to 30 April (inclusive). BMSB treatment of these goods will not be required.

Known risk pathways and supply chains

- Goods from known risk pathways and supply chains that have had previous detections of BMSB may be subject to BMSB intervention including treatment and/or inspections.

Treatment of BMSB goods between Australia and New Zealand

- The BMSB seasonal measures are for goods being imported into Australian territory, and managing the risk associated with those goods.
- Australia will not be conducting BMSB treatments for BMSB goods transshipping to NZ.
- Goods exported from Australia cannot be treated for BMSB in New Zealand and vice versa. For example, if the goods have been exported from Australia for not meeting BMSB import conditions, they will not be permitted to be treated in New Zealand for return to Australia, and vice versa.
- BMSB goods that have transhipped and/or entered New Zealand during the BMSB season and then shipped to Australia, will not be permitted into Australia without BMSB treatment that meets Australian BMSB requirements either offshore or onshore, where permitted.

The countries below have been categorised as target risk:

- Albania

- Andorra
- Armenia
- Austria
- Azerbaijan
- Belgium
- Bosnia and Herzegovina
- Bulgaria
- Canada
- China (heightened vessel surveillance only)
- Croatia
- Czechia
- France
- Japan (heightened vessel surveillance only).
- Georgia
- Germany
- Greece
- Hungary
- Italy
- Kazakhstan
- Republic of Korea (heightened vessel surveillance only)
- Kosovo
- Liechtenstein
- Luxembourg
- Montenegro
- Moldova
- Netherlands
- Poland
- Portugal
- Republic of North Macedonia
- Romania
- Russia
- Serbia
- Slovakia
- Slovenia
- Spain
- Switzerland
- Türkiye
- Ukraine
- United States of America
- Uzbekistan

The following countries have been identified as emerging risk countries for the -BMSB risk season and may be selected for a random onshore inspection: United Kingdom, China, Japan and Republic of Korea.

- Random inspections will apply to goods shipped from United Kingdom, China, Japan and Republic of Korea between 1 September to 30 April (inclusive).
- In addition to the target high risk goods, chapters 39, 94 and 95 will be subject to random inspections for emerging risk countries only.

Heightened vessel surveillance applies to all roll-on roll-off (Ro-Ro) vessels that have berthed, loaded or transhipped from target risk countries (with the addition of China, Japan and Republic of Korea) between 1 September and 30 June. These vessels will be subject to a mandatory seasonal pest (SP) inspection on arrival in Australian territory. This is only applicable to the Ro-Ro vessels themselves and does not apply to goods on the vessel.

Goods that fall within the following tariff classifications have been categorised as target high risk goods and will require mandatory treatment for BMSB risk.

- 44 - Wood and articles of wood; wood charcoal
- 45 - Cork and articles of cork
- 57 - Carpets and other textile floor coverings
- 68 - Articles of stone, plaster, cement, asbestos, mica or similar materials
- 69 - Ceramic products – including sub chapters I and II
- 70 – Glass and glass ware
- 72 - Iron and steel - including sub chapters I, II, III, IV
- 73 - Articles of iron or steel
- 74 - Copper and articles thereof
- 75 - Nickel and articles thereof
- 76 - Aluminium and articles thereof
- 78 - Lead and articles thereof
- 79 - Zinc and articles thereof
- 80 - Tin and articles thereof
- 81 - Other base metals; cermets; articles thereof
- 82 - Tools, implements, cutlery, spoons and forks, of base metal; parts thereof of base metal
- 83 - Miscellaneous articles of base metals
- 84 - Nuclear reactors, boilers, machinery and mechanical appliances; parts thereof
- 85 - Electrical machinery and equipment and parts thereof; sound recorders and reproducers, television image and sound recorders and reproducers, and parts and accessories of such articles
- 86 - Railway or tramway locomotives, rolling-stock and parts thereof; railway or tramway track fixtures and fittings and parts thereof; mechanical (including electro-mechanical) traffic signalling equipment of all kinds
- 87 - Vehicles other than railway or tramway rolling-stock, and parts and accessories thereof
- 88 - Aircraft, spacecraft, and parts thereof
- 89 - Ships, boats and floating structures

Goods that fall within the following tariff classifications have been categorised as target risk goods and are only subject to increased onshore intervention through random inspection. Mandatory treatment is not required.

- 27 - Mineral fuels, mineral oils and products of their distillation; bituminous substances; mineral waxes
- 28 - Inorganic chemicals; organic or inorganic compounds of precious metals, of rare-earth metals, of radioactive elements or of isotopes - including sub chapters I, II, III, IV and V
- 29 - Organic chemicals - including sub chapters I, II, III, IV, V, VI, VII, VIII, IX, X, XII and XIII
- 38 - Miscellaneous chemical products
- 39 - Plastics and articles thereof - – including sub chapters I and II
- 40 - Rubber and articles thereof
- 48 - Paper and paperboard; articles of paper pulp, of paper or of paperboard
- 49 - Printed books, newspapers, pictures and other products of the printing industry; manuscripts, typescripts and plans
- 56 - Wadding, felt and nonwovens; special yarns; twine, cordage, ropes and cables and articles thereof

For all other goods that are not categorised as target high risk and target risk goods, BMSB seasonal measures do not apply. However, if they are part of a container or consignment that contains target high risk or target risk goods, they will be subject to the measures.

All ro-ro vessels that berth at, load, or tranship in target risk countries between 1 September and 30 April (inclusive) will be required to:

- Conduct at least one crew inspection and respond to specific questions as part of the pre-arrival reporting requirements; and
- Undergo a mandatory seasonal pest inspection on arrival in Australia.

For further information on BMSB seasonal measures for vessels, visit the [Management of vessels](#) web page.

Treatment Rates

There are four approved treatment options for BMSB treatment.

The approved treatments are:

Heat

For all good types and sizes

- 56°C or higher at the coldest surface of the goods, for a minimum of 30 minutes
or
- for individual goods weighing less than 3000 kg shipped as break bulk only, 60°C or higher at the coldest surface of the goods, for a minimum of 10 minutes

Note: Individual goods shipped as break bulk weighing less than 3000kg treated at 60°C for 10 minutes require evidence within shipping documentation that they are less than 3000kg for these treatments to be accepted.

Methyl Bromide

- A dose of 24 g/m³ or above, at 10°C or above, for a minimum of 12 hours (but less than 24 hours), and a minimum end point reading of 12 g/m³
or
- A dose of 24 g/m³ or above, at 10°C or above, for 24 hours or longer, and a minimum end point reading of 8 g/m³

Note:

- All start time concentration readings must be above 24 g/m³.
- Dose increases to compensate for temperatures less than 10°C is NOT permitted.
- Topping up with additional fumigant at the end of treatment is NOT permitted.
- If the concentration of fumigant falls below the minimum end point reading at any point during the treatment, the treatment has failed.

Sulfuryl Fluoride

- A dose of 24 g/m³ or above, at 10°C or above, for a minimum of 12 hours (but less than 24 hours), and a minimum end point reading of 12 g/m³
or
- A dose of 24 g/m³ or above, at 10°C or above, for 24 hours or longer, and a minimum end point reading of 8 g/m³

Note:

- All start time concentration readings must be above 24 g/m³.
- Dose increases to compensate for temperatures less than 10°C is NOT permitted.
- Topping up with additional fumigant at the end of treatment is NOT permitted.
- If the concentration of fumigant falls below the minimum end point reading at any point during the treatment, the treatment has failed.

Sulfuryl Fluoride – Using third-party system*

- Achieve a CT of 200 g-h/m³ or more, at 10°C or above, for 12 hours or longer, with a minimum end point reading of 12 g/m³
or
- Achieve a CT of 200 g-h/m³ or more, at 10°C or above, for 24 hours or longer, with a minimum end point reading of 8 g/m³

***Note:**

The approved stewardship program operators and their third party programs are:

- Douglas Products or their agents - FumiGuide
- Ensystex II, Inc. (USA) - Fumicalc
- Barcan Barcan Pest Control & Fumigation Co. (Barcan ilaclama Fumigasyon Tic. Ltd.Sti.) (Turkey) - FumiTrack

Topping up with additional fumigant at the end of treatment is NOT permitted. If the concentration of fumigant falls below the minimum end point reading at any point during the treatment, the treatment has failed.

Ethyl Formate

For a formulation of 16.7% ethyl formate with 83.3% carbon dioxide

- A dose rate of 20 g/m³ Ethyl formate and 100 g/m³ carbon dioxide or above, at 10°C or above or
- A dose rate of 120 g/m³ premix ethyl formate and carbon dioxide or above, at 10°C or above.

All treatments must comply with the following tabled concentration and exposure period requirements:

Minimum initial concentration for ethyl formate	Minimum initial concentration for carbon dioxide	Exposure period	Minimum final concentration for ethyl formate	Minimum final concentration reading for carbon dioxide
18 g/m ³	90 g/m ³	4 hours	15 g/m ³	70 g/m ³
17 g/m ³	85 g/m ³	4 hours 5 minutes	15 g/m ³	70 g/m ³
16 g/m ³	80 g/m ³	4 hours 15 minutes	15 g/m ³	70 g/m ³
15 g/m ³	75 g/m ³	4 hours 30 minutes	15 g/m ³	70 g/m ³

Note:

- Dose increases to compensate for temperatures less than 10°C is NOT permitted.
- Topping up with additional fumigant at the end of treatment is NOT permitted.
- If the concentration of fumigant falls below the minimum end point reading at any point during the treatment, the treatment has failed.

Treatment minimum standards

There are set [minimum standards](#) for the application of BMSB treatments. Treatments applied for biosecurity purposes are part of managing the risk of introducing exotic pests and diseases.

It is important that treatment providers understand these requirements as treatments to manage risk are only effective when conducted correctly. These standards outline best practice methodologies for applying biosecurity treatments.

Onshore treatment

Where onshore treatment of goods is permitted, you can find a [list of approved arrangement providers](#) on the department's website.

Offshore treatment

[AusTreat](#) sets out the department's registration and compliance requirements for offshore treatment providers, including compliance with applicable treatment methodologies.

Further information can be found on the [AusTreat](#) webpage.

Treatment providers in target risk countries

All offshore treatment providers performing BMSB treatments in target risk countries must be registered under [AusTreat](#) and listed as 'approved' on the [List of treatment providers](#) prior to treatment. Treatments conducted by an unapproved treatment provider in a target risk country will be deemed as invalid and the goods will be subject to onshore treatment (if permitted) or directed for export.

Treatment providers in non-target risk countries

Treatment providers in other countries who intend to conduct BMSB treatments for goods that are manufactured in or shipped from any of the target risk countries are encouraged to register under an [offshore treatment assurance scheme](#).

Treatment certificates issued by a treatment provider in non-target risk country will be accepted unless the:

- treatment provider is listed as 'suspended', 'withdrawn' or 'under review' on the [List of treatment providers](#),
or
- unregistered treatment provider is listed as 'unacceptable' or 'under review' on our [webpage](#).

Fraudulent certificates

The department continues to improve its systems to monitor and detect the use of fraudulent certificates and will identify consignments that arrive in Australia with fraudulent documentation.

Any consignment identified with a fraudulent certificate will be directed for onshore treatment (if permitted) or exported.

BMSB Materials

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

BMSB Fact Sheets

Download

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

Templates for Documentary Evidence

The following templates are available on the [Preparing to import BMSB goods page](#)

Templates include:

- Sealing declarations
- Transshipment declarations
- BMSB NUFT manufacturers declarations.

BMSB Industry Presentations

Download

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

See. Secure. Report.

If you see something that could have entered Australia with imported goods report it to See. Secure. Report. on 1800 798 636 or complete the [online form](#).

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/before/brown-marmorated-stink-bugs>